Engineering Handbook

This handbook applies to every engineer at Northwind Labs, remote or in the Lisbon and Toronto offices. It replaces version 2026.1 and takes effect on 1 October 2026.

Code review

Every change reaches main through a pull request. A pull request needs one approving review from a code owner of the repository. Maintainers merge; authors never merge their own pull requests. Reviews are answered within one working day.

Branches

Feature branches are named after the issue, for example feat/142-retry-webhooks. Branches are deleted after the merge. Force pushes to main are blocked for everyone.

Working hours

Core hours are 11:00 to 15:00 in the engineer's local time zone. Meetings outside core hours are optional.

Learning budget

Each engineer has a learning budget of 1,500 USD per calendar year for books, courses and conferences. Requests go to the engineering lead in the people portal.